

G5-P01

4 WEEKENDS, 4 PROJECTS

A clear path to work in small steps

Bonus
Included

Illustrated Work Calendar

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Color Theory Basics

The core principles behind every beautiful color combination — simplified for yarn.

You do not need an art degree to pick colors that look great together. A few simple rules will guide you toward combinations that feel balanced, intentional, and polished.

The Color Wheel

Every color relationship starts with the color wheel. Understanding three categories is enough:

CATEGORY	COLORS	WHAT THEY ARE
Primary	Red, Yellow, Blue	The three colors that cannot be mixed from other colors. All other colors come from combinations of these.
Secondary	Orange, Green, Violet	Made by mixing two primaries: red + yellow = orange, yellow + blue = green, blue + red = violet.
Tertiary	Red-orange, Yellow-orange, Yellow-green, Blue-green, Blue-violet, Red-violet	Made by mixing a primary with an adjacent secondary. These give you the in-between tones that are often the most useful in home decor.

Warm vs. Cool Tones

Every color leans warm or cool, and this distinction drives the feeling of a room:

WARM TONES	COOL TONES
Red, orange, yellow, gold, terracotta, rust, coral, peach, warm brown	Blue, green, violet, teal, slate, sage, lavender, cool gray
Feel: cozy, inviting, energizing, intimate	Feel: calming, refreshing, spacious, serene
Best for: living rooms, kitchens, dining areas	Best for: bedrooms, bathrooms, reading nooks

Color Relationships

These are the four most useful color combinations for home decor crochet:

RELATIONSHIP	WHAT IT IS	EFFECT	EXAMPLE
Complementary	Two colors directly opposite each other on the wheel	High contrast, bold, eye-catching	Blue + orange, red + green, yellow + violet
Analogous	Three colors next to each other on the wheel	Harmonious, natural, easy on the eyes	Blue + blue-green + green, red + red-orange + orange
Triadic	Three colors evenly spaced around the wheel (120° apart)	Vibrant, balanced, playful	Red + yellow + blue, orange + green + violet
Split-Complementary	One color + the two colors adjacent to its complement	High contrast but less tension than pure complementary	Blue + yellow-orange + red-orange

How Yarn Texture Affects Color

Color does not exist in isolation — texture changes how we see it:

- **Matte cotton** shows the truest color. What you see on the skein is what you get in the finished piece.
- **Shiny or mercerized cotton** reflects light, making colors appear brighter and more saturated.
- **Fuzzy yarns** (mohair, boucle) soften and mute colors. A bright red becomes a dusty rose.
- **Variegated or self-stripping yarns** break up solid color. They can clash with complex stitch patterns because both compete for attention.
- **Heathered yarns** (flecks of different colors spun together) read as muted, complex tones — excellent for natural, farmhouse looks.

Practical Tip

When choosing colors for a project with textured stitches (bobbles, cables, popcorns), use solid, light-to-medium colors. Dark and variegated yarns hide the texture you worked so hard to create.

SECTION 2

Room-by-Room Color Palettes

Ready-to-use color combinations for every room in your home, with yarn color names you can shop for.

Each room in your home has a different purpose and mood. These palettes are designed to match those moods, with three options per room so you can pick the one that fits your existing decor.

Living Room

The living room is where your home decor crochet will get the most attention. Aim for warmth and sophistication.

PALETTE A — WARM NEUTRALS

Linen

Cafe Latte

Cream

Honey

Warm, inviting, works with wood furniture and leather. Use Cream as the dominant color, Linen and Cafe Latte as supporting, Honey as the accent.

PALETTE B — EARTH & FOREST

Sage

Mustard

Off-White

Walnut

Nature-inspired and grounding. Off-White as dominant, Sage and Walnut as supporting, Mustard as the accent pop.

PALETTE C — MODERN CLASSIC

Charcoal

Stone

White

Dark Gold

Elegant and timeless. White/Stone as dominant, Charcoal for structure, Dark Gold for warmth and accent.

Bedroom

Calm and restful. Avoid high-contrast combinations and overly bright tones.

PALETTE A — SOFT CLOUD

Oatmeal

Taupe

White

Blush

Soft, peaceful, pairs with light wood. White as dominant, Oatmeal and Taupe for depth, Blush for gentle warmth.

PALETTE B — OCEAN CALM

Sky Blue

Slate Blue

Ivory

Sea Glass

Cool and tranquil. Ivory as dominant, Sky Blue and Slate Blue for calm tones, Sea Glass as the organic accent.

PALETTE C — LAVENDER DREAM

Lavender

Lilac

Whisper

Dusty Plum

Romantic and soothing. Whisper as dominant, Lavender and Lilac as supporting, Dusty Plum for subtle contrast.

Kitchen

Practical and cheerful. Kitchen crochet needs to look clean even after use, so choose colors that forgive small stains.

PALETTE A — FARMHOUSE FRESH

White

Forest Green

Natural

Saddle Brown

Country charm. White and Natural as dominant, Forest Green and Brown for farmhouse warmth.

PALETTE B — CITRUS BRIGHT

Cream

Sunflower

Tangerine

Herb Green

Energizing and warm. Cream as dominant, Sunflower and Herb Green as supporting, Tangerine as accent.

PALETTE C — CLEAN & CLASSIC

White

Steel Blue

Pebble

Charcoal

Modern and fresh. White as dominant, Steel Blue for a clean pop, Pebble and Charcoal for grounding.

Bathroom

Spa-like serenity. Think water, stone, and natural fibers.

PALETTE A — SPA RETREAT

White

Eucalyptus

Sand

Jade

Clean and calming. White and Sand as dominant, Eucalyptus and Jade for a natural spa feel.

PALETTE B — COASTAL

Driftwood

Seafoam

Soft White

Ocean Blue

Beach-house vibe. Soft White and Driftwood as dominant, Seafoam and Ocean Blue as accents.

PALETTE C — WARM STONE

Linen

Sandstone

White

Dune

Warm and earthy. White and Linen as dominant, Sandstone and Dune for depth. Pairs with wood accents.

Children's Room

Playful but not overwhelming. Bright colors in small doses, balanced with plenty of neutrals.

PALETTE A — RAINBOW SOFT

Cream

Soft Coral

Baby Blue

Buttercup

Cheerful but gentle. Cream as dominant (60%), one supporting color (30%), one accent (10%). Rotate which bright is the accent.

PALETTE B — SAFARI

Tan

Jungle Green

Camel

Rust

Adventurous and warm. Tan as dominant, Jungle Green and Camel as supporting, Rust for energy.

PALETTE C — STORYBOOK

White

Powder Blue

Cloud

Sunshine

Gentle and dreamy. White and Cloud as dominant, Powder Blue for calm, Sunshine for a warm glow.

SECTION 3

Seasonal Color Schemes

Refresh your home decor throughout the year by swapping accent pieces in seasonal colors.

You do not need to redecorate your entire home each season. A few crocheted cushion covers, a table runner, or a set of coasters in seasonal colors is enough to transform the feeling of a room.

Spring

Fresh, light, renewed. Think of the first flowers breaking through after winter.

SPRING PALETTE

Cherry Blossom

Mint

Daffodil

Wisteria

White

How to use: White or Mint as the base. Cherry Blossom and Wisteria for delicate accents. Daffodil sparingly for pops of warmth. Best for: placemats, light throws, small cushions.

Summer

Bright, confident, sun-soaked. Bolder colors work here because natural light balances them.

SUMMER PALETTE

Sand

Teal

Coral

Lemon

White

How to use: Sand and White as the base. Teal as the primary accent. Coral and Lemon as pops — use one at a time, not both at full strength. Best for: outdoor cushions, coasters, bright table runners.

Autumn

Warm, rich, grounded. These are the colors of harvest and comfort.

AUTUMN PALETTE

Burnt Orange

Amber

Burgundy

Olive

Natural

How to use: Natural as the base. Burnt Orange and Amber for warmth. Olive for earthy grounding. Burgundy sparingly for depth. Best for: blankets, chunky cushion covers, table centerpieces.

Winter

Rich, cozy, festive. Deeper tones and heavier textures signal warmth and celebration.

WINTER PALETTE

Charcoal

Cranberry

Ivory

Gold

Evergreen

How to use: Ivory as the base. Charcoal and Evergreen for depth and richness. Cranberry for warmth. Gold as a festive accent — metallic yarn in small doses (edging, a single stripe) adds luxury. Best for: throw blankets, oversized cushions, holiday table runners.

Quick-Swap Strategy

Instead of making entirely new pieces for each season, crochet cushion covers with removable inserts. Four sets of covers (one per season) can transform a living room in minutes. Store off-season covers in a cotton pillowcase to keep them dust-free and prevent yellowing.

Color Dos and Don'ts

Simple rules that prevent costly mistakes and keep your color choices looking intentional.

The most common color mistakes are not about choosing the wrong color — they are about using the right colors in the wrong proportions or combinations.

The 60-30-10 Rule

This is the single most useful rule for color in home decor. It works for rooms and for individual crochet projects:

PROPORTION	ROLE	WHAT IT DOES	EXAMPLE (BLANKET)
60%	Dominant color	Sets the overall mood. Usually a neutral or soft tone.	Cream — the base of most rows
30%	Supporting color	Adds depth and visual interest. A deeper or complementary shade.	Sage green — alternating stripes
10%	Accent color	Creates focal points and energy. The boldest color, used sparingly.	Mustard — a single stripe or border

Don't: Too Many Colors

Using 5 or more colors in equal amounts creates visual chaos. Every color competes for attention and nothing stands out. The piece looks busy instead of beautiful. Stick to 3 colors maximum for home decor projects, and let the proportions do the work.

Do: Let One Color Lead

Pick your favorite color for the 60% role. Choose a second color that complements it for the 30% role. Then find a small accent for the 10%. If in doubt, make the 60% color a neutral (white, cream, gray, beige) — neutrals anchor almost any combination.

Don't: Ignore the Room

A beautiful teal cushion will look out of place in a room with warm terracotta walls and brown furniture. Before choosing yarn colors, photograph your room in natural daylight and identify the dominant tones already present. Your crochet piece should complement them, not fight them.

Do: Pull Colors from What's Already There

Look at your existing furniture, curtains, rugs, and wall colors. Pick your yarn colors from that existing palette. Your crochet piece will look like it belongs from day one. A simple trick: take a photo of the room and use a color picker app to extract the exact colors present.

Don't: Over-Match

Making everything in the room the exact same shade of blue looks sterile and flat. Slight variations in tone create depth. Instead of matching your cushion to your curtains exactly, pick a yarn in the same color family but a shade lighter or darker.

Do: Vary Shades Within a Color Family

A monochromatic scheme (different shades of one color) is one of the easiest and most elegant approaches. For example: a blanket in light sage, medium sage, and dark sage, with a cream border. Three shades of the same color always look cohesive.

Don't: Mix Clashing Textures with Clashing Colors

A fuzzy mohair in bright orange next to a smooth cotton in neon green creates double visual stress — both the textures and the colors fight each other. If you are mixing textures (which can look beautiful), keep the colors closely related. If you are mixing bold colors, keep the textures similar.

Do: Test in the Actual Room

Colors look different under store lighting, sunlight, and your home's lamp light. Before buying enough yarn for a full project, buy one skein and hold it in the room where the finished piece will live. Check it in daylight and at night under your room's lights. This single step prevents the most common color regrets.

Practical Swatching

How to test your color choices before committing to a full project — and avoid expensive mistakes.

A 15-minute swatch can save you 15 hours of work and \$50 in yarn. Swatching for color is just as important as swatching for gauge, and most crocheters skip it.

Why Swatch for Color

- **Skein vs. stitch:** A color looks completely different wound in a skein versus worked up in stitches. The stitch structure creates shadows and highlights that change the overall tone.
- **Colors interact:** Two colors that look great individually can clash when placed next to each other in alternating rows. The only way to know is to swatch them together.
- **Screen vs. reality:** If you chose colors from a website or app, the actual yarn may be very different from what your screen showed.
- **Dye lot variation:** Even the same color from the same brand can shift between dye lots. If you mix lots in one project, the difference may be visible.

How Lighting Changes Yarn Colors

LIGHT SOURCE	EFFECT ON COLORS	WHAT TO WATCH FOR
Natural daylight (north-facing)	Truest color rendering	This is your baseline — evaluate colors here first
Direct sunlight	Washes out colors, makes them appear lighter	Sun-facing rooms need slightly deeper tones to compensate
Warm incandescent / warm LED	Adds yellow. Blues look greener, whites look creamy	Cool-toned yarns may look muddy under warm light
Cool LED / fluorescent	Adds blue. Warm tones look duller, greens look cooler	Warm-toned yarns may lose their coziness
Evening lamplight	Generally warm, lower intensity	Test your swatch at night if the piece will be seen mostly in the evening

Photographing Swatches

Photos help you compare options and remember your decisions. Follow these rules for accurate photos:

- Shoot in natural daylight, near a window but not in direct sun.

- Place the swatch on a neutral gray or white surface (not on a colored tablecloth).
- Turn off your phone's flash — it distorts colors.
- Include a white sheet of paper in the frame as a reference so you can adjust later.
- Photograph all your options together in one shot so you can compare them side by side.

Color Selection Process

- ☐ Identify the room and mood (Section 2)
- ☐ Choose a palette (or build your own using Section 1)
- ☐ Buy one skein of each color
- ☐ Crochet a swatch combining all colors (at least 10 rows)
- ☐ View the swatch in the actual room, in daylight
- ☐ View the swatch in the room at night, under the room's lights
- ☐ Photograph the swatch for reference
- ☐ Decide: keep, swap one color, or start over
- ☐ Buy the full quantity only after the swatch passes

Step-by-Step Swatching Guide

- 1 Choose your stitch pattern.** Use the same stitch the pattern calls for, not just single crochet. The stitch affects how the color reads — a shell stitch shows more of a color than a tight single crochet.
- 2 Chain a 15 cm (6") wide foundation.** This is wide enough to see the color at scale. A tiny swatch does not show how the color will look across a large area.
- 3 Work 4–5 rows in each color you plan to use.** If you are doing stripes, replicate the stripe pattern. If all one color with an accent border, work the main color and then add 2 rows of the accent.
- 4 Fasten off but do not cut the yarn.** You may want to add more rows if the first test is inconclusive.
- 5 Take the swatch to the room.** Hold it against the wall, the couch, the table — wherever the finished piece will go. Step back 2–3 meters and look at it from the distance you normally see that spot.
- 6 Check at multiple times of day.** Morning light, afternoon light, and evening lamplight can make the same swatch look like three different palettes.

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Ask yourself three questions: Does it blend with the room? Does the accent pop without overwhelming? Would I be happy seeing this every day for a year?

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If the answer is yes to all three: proceed. Buy all the yarn you need in the same dye lot. If any answer is no, swap the problem color and swatch again. The cost of one extra skein is always less than the cost of frogging a half-finished blanket.

Save Your Swatches

Pin each swatch to an index card with the yarn brand, color name, color number, and dye lot written on it. Keep these cards together. When you start a new project, you can hold old swatches against your room instead of buying new yarn to test. Over time, you will build a personal color library that makes future decisions faster.

Next Step

Color is one of the most powerful tools you have as a maker. With the palettes and techniques in this guide, you can transform any room in your home — one crocheted piece at a time.

Choose your first palette from Section 2, grab a skein of each color, and swatch. Once you see your colors come alive in stitches, you will know exactly which pattern to start with.

Happy crocheting!